

COLUMN | VINAY SINHA

Understanding the Future of PC Gaming

The pandemic has transformed how we use technology to live, work, play and communicate. During the outbreak, people were compelled to seek out new forms of entertainment. India has one of the youngest populations in the world, and this resulted in the emergence of gaming as a popular pastime as it served as a medium for people to get together, collaborate and build a community virtually.

Increasingly diverse needs

Even amongst gamers, users have a wide range of requirements from their hardware – which can range from casual mobile gaming to e-sports and competitive gaming.

Competitive pro-gamers seek PCs exclusively built for gaming as they require more cores, higher clock-speeds, and the best GPU performance to make the most of today's high-end displays. In contrast, casual gamers may seek a more multi-purpose PC, as they find that their needs are met with a device that can also be used for work.

Innovation is necessary to effectively cater to evolving needs and create immersive gaming experiences for all gamers. Processor performance plays a critical role in delivering the best experience for a wide variety of uses. The future is therefore going to be about innovation and creating immersive experiences, where hardware capabilities such as those delivered by AMD will enable and empower PC gaming beyond expectations across all gaming interests.

Growing Interest in Gaming PC builds

In the gaming segment, a growing interest in DIY PC building can be primarily attributed to the desire for gamers to hyper-personalize their PCs. Another reason why custom-

built PCs are so appealing is because users have significant flexibility to scale and transform their PCs.

AMD's latest Ryzen™ 5000 Series Desktop CPUs brought leadership performance across single and multi-thread workloads, excellent gaming performance and core and thread counts optimized for high-performance and to dominate in heavily threaded workloads.

Also integral to a gaming system is the GPU. Harnessing the breakthrough AMD RDNA™ 2 architecture and paired with advanced features such as the AMD FidelityFX Super Resolution (FSR) and Radeon Boost, the AMD Radeon RX 6000 Series elevates the gaming experience to new levels of realism.

Other Trends: E-sports

In India, according to a study by EY, “the e-sports industry is expected to grow at 46% CAGR over the next four years and streaming platforms will generate the largest chunk of e-sport revenues”.

Professional e-sports simply is not possible without incredibly powerful technology driving its high gaming performance and streaming demands. Gamers expect fluid performance both in practice and during matches.

Next-Gen Gaming Technologies

AMD has collaborated with our global PC partners to integrate the AMD Advantage design framework into their premium products, redefining the next generation of premium, high-performance gaming laptops. The first AMD Advantage laptops are already available from leading OEMs.

At an architecture level, we launched “Zen 3” and AMD RDNA 2 last year on leading edge 7nm process technology and continue to deliver a high level of performance across



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desktop and notebook platforms to consumers with a roadmap to deliver more gains as we move forward. There is also considerable excitement in the market with the next-generation game console launches from Sony and Microsoft, powered by AMD.

From a feature perspective we recently unveiled AMD FSR, a cutting-edge spatial upscaling technology designed to boost frame rates to deliver a high-quality, high-resolution gaming experience.

Conclusion

To conclude, it has been clearly established that the gaming landscape has and will continue to rapidly transform – not just in India, but on a global scale. It has to be recognised that at the heart of the gaming industry's growth and transformation is a single intangible factor: Passion.

Passion demands performance, and few are as passionate as those in gaming and entertainment. Whether consumers are developing or playing games casually or competitively, their passion pushes hardware manufacturers like AMD, our partners and game developers to constantly work towards elevating the gaming experience through innovation. **d**